

2. Conversing

- Underlying model of having a conversation with another human
- Range from simple voice recognition menu-driven systems to more complex 'natural language' dialogs
- Examples include timetables, search engines, advice-giving systems, help systems
- Also virtual agents, toys and pet robots designed to converse with you

Would you talk with Anna?

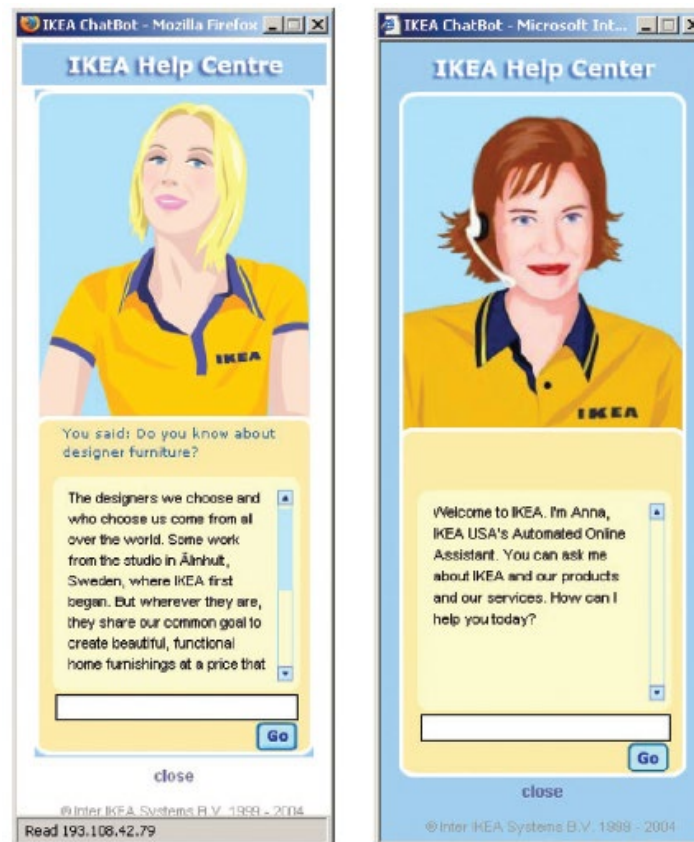


Figure 1.7 Anna the online sales agent, designed to be subtly different for UK and US customers. What are the differences and which is which? What should Anna's appearance be like for other countries, like India, South Africa, or China?

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Pros and cons of conversational model

- Allows users, especially novices and technophobes, to interact with the system in a way that is familiar
 - makes them feel comfortable, at ease and less scared
- Misunderstandings can arise when the system does not know how to parse what the user says